



APRIL 15th 2026

COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE SESSION A

MEETING AGENDA

Date: Wednesday April 15, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: 108 E Green Street Council Chambers 3rd Floor
Watch Online: <https://www.youtube.com/@CityofIthacaPublicMeetings>

1. **Call To Order (5 Min)**
 - 1.1. Emergency Evacuation Order
 - 1.2. Agenda Review
2. **Public Hearing- Economic & Community Development (60 Min)**
 - 2.1. Proposal to Allow Planned Unit Developments (PUD) Citywide
3. **Petitions and Hearings of Persons Before Council (30Min)**
4. **Finance & Administration (25 Min)**
 - 4.1. [Communications Updates and Relunched Website](#)
5. **Economic & Community Development (25 Min)**
 - 5.1. [Proposal to Allow Planned Unit Developments \(PUD\) Citywide](#)
6. **Meeting Wrap-Up**

Public Comment

The public can provide short statements during this portion of the meeting. 3 minutes is the maximum time allotted, but the chair reserves the right to modify the amount of time per individual at the start of the meeting. Only the first hour of the meeting is set aside for Public Comment. **Groups of 3 or More Speakers are Allotted more speaking time.**

For Longer Speaking Time- Multiple Speakers on the same topic can speak as a group with one Designated Speaker to represent the Group. This will give you more time to share your thoughts and concerns during the Public Comment Forum.

3-4 Persons with One Designated Speaker -Allotted 5 Minutes

5-7 or More Persons with One Designated Speaker – Allotted 7 Minutes

Attending The Meeting To Speak In Person? Pre-Registration Not Required. Comment Cards are provided to those who attend in Person. Once you have filled out your Comment Card, please hand your card to the Clerk. Your name will be called to speak in the order the cards are received.

Please Note Comment Cards will be accepted up until Public Comment Forum begins or a maximum of 30 speakers, whichever comes first. Once we have reached a Maximum of 30 Speakers you can submit your comment using the Written Comment Link Below.

Want To Submit A Comment and Not Speak In Person?

To Submit Written Comments - [Click Here To Submit Written Comment](#)

**Written comments submitted will be compiled and entered into the record.*

Can't Come To The Meeting But Still Want To Speak? Register To Speak Virtually [Click Here To Register](#)



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Public Information and Technology
Shaniqua Lewis, Deputy City Clerk

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING A
FROM: Department of Information and Community Engagement
DATE: April 15, 2026
RE: Communications Updates and Relaunched Website
ITEM #: 4.1

Informing Common Council and the public on goals, actions and future plans of the DICE Communications Division. This includes the newly launched (April 8) website, CivicSend newsletters, increased use of press releases and more.

ATTACHMENTS:

[Briefing-Memo-Elected-Leaders-20260415.pdf](#)



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION &
COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT
Alan Karasin, Director, PIO, City Clerk

Telephone: 607-274-6570
Fax: 607-274-6432
www.cityofithaca.org

To: Mayor Robert Cantelmo and Common Council
From: Alan Karasin, Director, Department of Information and Community Engagement

Date: April 15, 2026

Purpose:

This memo provides an update on recent work by the DICE (Department of Information and Community Engagement) Communications Division, including the launch of the City's redesigned website and CivicSend, the expansion of City communication channels referenced in the April 8, 2026 City Manager's report, the new summary of Common Council legislative actions, and key areas of focus for upcoming communications planning. This work supports legislative policy alignment: Public Works and Operations.

Recent Communications Actions:

Website and CivicSend Launch

On Wednesday, April 8, 2026, the City launched its redesigned public website along with CivicSend, a new email newsletter and targeted communications platform. Staff were notified in advance through an internal email outlining what was launching, what would change, and how questions would be handled during the transition.

The website redesign responds to long-standing feedback from residents and staff regarding difficulty finding information, unclear organization, and accessibility issues.

Improvements include:

- Easier navigation based on how residents look for information
- Stronger ADA accessibility features
- Clearer layout and organization of services
- Updated look and branding consistent across pages
-

While the home page layout and navigation changed, all existing content, departmental pages, and URLs remain intact. This approach limits disruption while improving usability and access.

CivicSend is now the City's primary tool for newsletters and targeted public updates. It allows residents, partners, and stakeholders to subscribe by topic, improving consistency

"An Equal Opportunity Employee with a commitment to workforce diversification"

while reducing the need for broad, untargeted messaging. This approach supports clearer communication, better targeting, and improved transparency. Current CivicSend subscription lists include:

- Actions of Common Council
- City Manager Updates
- Employment
- Parks and Recreation
- Planning and Development
- Public Safety
- Roads, Sidewalks and Infrastructure
- Sustainability
- Youth Program

Community members can sign up for one or more lists at:

<https://www.cityofithacany.gov/list.aspx>

Some questions were expected as staff and residents adjusted to the new site. The Communications team has served as the central point for responding to questions, troubleshooting issues, and guiding both staff and the public during the transition. This helped avoid duplication of effort and ensured consistent responses.

Expanded Communication Channels

As outlined in the April 8, 2026 City Manager's report, the City has expanded how it communicates with the public.

These changes include:

- Increased use of newsletters and targeted email lists through CivicSend
- More coordinated media outreach and clearer [internal] expectations for media response
- Improved internal coordination around messaging and public questions
- Early efforts to strengthen two-way communication between residents and City leadership

Collectively, this work moves the City away from mostly one-way communication and toward a more consistent, proactive, and accessible approach.

Legislative Actions Summary

DICE now produces a plain-language summary of Common Council legislative actions following each regular voting meeting. These summaries:

- Highlight key Council actions in clear, non-technical language
- Provide context for what decisions mean for the community
- Are distributed through City communication channels and shared with media and partners
- Supplement, but do not replace, formal agendas and meeting minutes

This tool improves transparency and helps residents understand Council decisions without having to navigate lengthy documents.

Upcoming Communications Planning

Emergency Communications

A focus of upcoming work is the development of a Citywide Emergency Communications plan. While departments and public safety agencies have operational procedures, the City does not currently have a fully defined communications framework for emergencies or rapidly evolving situations.

This planning effort will focus on:

- Clearly defining communication roles during an emergency
- Establishing approval and information-sharing protocols
- Coordinating among DICE, the City Manager's Office, the Mayor, Public Safety, and I.T.
- Identifying communication tools, templates, and distribution methods that can be used quickly

This work is ongoing and will require collaboration across departments. The goal is clarity and readiness before an emergency occurs, not during one.

Ongoing Communications Development

Additional planning priorities include:

- Refining a citywide annual communications calendar organized by seasonal and operational themes (attached to this memo)
- Enhancing two-way communication through the Community Feedback tool
- Supporting departments in sharing updates about projects, programs, and services
- Improving internal communication tools and feedback opportunities for staff via the Intranet
- Continuing work on consistent branding and messaging across City platforms

These efforts support transparency, trust, and timely access to accurate information.

Conclusion

The launch of the redesigned City website and CivicSend represent a meaningful improvement in how Ithaca communicates with residents, partners, and visitors. Along with expanded communication channels, new legislative summaries, and focused planning efforts, DICE is building a clearer, more consistent, and more resilient communications approach.

This work will continue in coordination with Common Council, the City Manager, and City departments.

Annual Messaging Cycle Template

January – Winter Operations & Holiday Schedules

Themes: Holiday closures, State of the City address, winter parking rules, snow/ice removal, winter safety, frozen pipes.

Key Actions: Update closure dates, refresh winter parking maps, schedule safety reminders.

February – Mid-Winter Safety & Recreation

Themes: Storm readiness, hydrant access, indoor recreation, frozen pipe prevention.

Key Actions: Issue mid-winter safety flash, promote GIAC/Cass Park programs.

March – Spring Readiness

Themes: Storm drains, flood awareness, pothole reporting, park prep.

Key Actions: Launch spring readiness campaign, update park reservation info.

April – Earth Month & Seasonal Services

Themes: Sustainability, Earth Day logistics, Arbor Day, yard waste/brush collection, composting, street cleaning, fire hydrant testing.

Key Actions: Publish Earth Month series, coordinate with DIA for Earth Day.

May – Parks, Waterfront & Summer Prep, Construction season

Themes: Park openings, water safety, Memorial Day closures, summer program registration, Construction season plan.

Key Actions: Update park hours, publish water safety reminders, overview of construction projects.

June – Pride, Juneteenth & Heat Safety

Themes: Event logistics, inclusion messaging, youth programs, cooling locations, Farmers Market reminders.

Key Actions: Coordinate event logistics messaging, schedule heat safety reminders.

July – Independence Day & Peak Summer

Themes: Fireworks logistics, parks etiquette, waterfront safety, heat safety.

Key Actions: Publish July 4th logistics flash, run summer recreation reminders.

August – Move-In & Back-to-School

Themes: Student move-in operations, solid waste guidance, neighborhood relations, school safety.

Key Actions: Prepare move-in disposal guidance, coordinate with Cornell/IC.

September – Apple Fest, Budget Season, Boards/Committees recruitment

Themes: Event logistics, emergency preparedness, fall recreation, early leaf reminders, city budget presentation to final approval, volunteer opportunities.

Key Actions: Launch preparedness campaign, coordinate Apple Fest logistics, announce budget meeting schedule and public hearings, volunteer openings on boards/committees.

October – Halloween & Fall Services, Preparedness Month

Themes: Halloween safety, leaf collection, fire safety.

Key Actions: Publish leaf collection schedule, issue Halloween safety flash.

November – Winter Parking & Holiday Closures

Themes: Winter parking rules, winter prep, Veterans Day/Thanksgiving closures, tree trimming.

Key Actions: Launch winter parking campaign, publish holiday schedules.

December – Holiday Events & Winter Readiness

Themes: Downtown holiday logistics, Winter Light Festival, severe weather readiness, shelter info, year-end reminders, holiday closings

Key Actions: Coordinate with DIA, schedule storm readiness reminders, publish year-end service updates.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Planning & Economic Development
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING A
FROM: Megan Wilson
DATE: April 15, 2026
RE: Proposal to Allow Planned Unit Developments (PUD) Citywide
ITEM #: 5.1

Proposal to eliminate the Planned Unit Development Overlay District and allow Planned Unit Developments throughout the city

ATTACHMENTS:

[PUD ORD 2026-.pdf](#)

[PUD_Amendment_2026_Circulation_Packet__1__Megan_Wilson.pdf](#)

An Ordinance Amending Ithaca City Code Chapter § 325-12, “Planned unit developments (PUD)”

WHEREAS, creation of a Planned Unit Development (PUD) is a legislative rezoning process at the sole discretion of Council and results in a unique zoning district with defined area and use requirements, and

WHEREAS, since PUDs require long-term community benefits, allowing PUDs in all areas of the City can enable high-quality, community-enhancing projects to be built through the City’s neighborhoods, and

WHEREAS, Common Council desires to allow Planned Unit Developments (PUDs) throughout the City of Ithaca to provide an opportunity for more progressive zoning while a lengthier comprehensive rewrite is underway, and

WHEREAS, the Common Council of the City of Ithaca desires to amend Chapter 325 of the Ithaca City Code in order to allow Planned Unit Developments throughout the City of Ithaca; now, therefore

ORDINANCE 20-

BE IT ORDAINED AND ENACTED by the Common Council of the City of Ithaca as follows:

Section 1. Legislative findings, intent, and purpose.

Planned Unit Developments (PUDs) allow for more creative use of land than is permitted under current zoning, provided that a project has long-term community benefits and is compatible with the City’s comprehensive plan. Currently, PUDs are restricted to the City’s Planned Unit Development Overlay District (PUDOD). The proposed amendment would allow PUDs throughout the entire City, enabling high-quality, community-enhancing projects to be built in all neighborhoods.

Section 2. Amendments to Chapter § 325-12 of the Ithaca City Code

The following portions of Chapter § 325-12 of the Ithaca City Code are hereby amended as follows:¹

§ 325-12. Planned unit developments (PUD).

- A. Declaration of legislative authority. This Planned Unit Development (PUD) Ordinance is being enacted pursuant to the authority established in the New York State General City Law § 81-f.
- B. Purpose and intent.
 - (1) This legislation is intended to institute procedures and requirements for the

¹ Strikethrough indicates removals. Underlining indicates additions. Ellipses (...) indicate the omitted text remains unaltered.

establishment and mapping of PUDs, which may be placed in any location approved by the Common Council within the City of Ithaca, ~~as long as it is located within the Planned Unit Development Overlay District (PUDOD), the boundaries of which can be seen on the map entitled "Proposed Boundary for the Planned Unit Development Overlay District (PUDOD) — October 2021."~~² The PUD is a tool intended to encourage mixed-use or unique single use projects that require more creative and imaginative design of land development than is possible under standard zoning district regulations. A PUD allows for flexibility in planning and design, while ensuring efficient investment in public improvements, environmental sensitivity, and protection of community character. A PUD should be used only when long-term community benefits will be achieved through high quality development, including, but not limited to, reduced traffic demands, greater quality and quantity of public and/or private open space, community recreational amenities, needed housing types and/or mix, innovative designs, and protection and/or preservation of natural resources.

- (2) Section 325-12 is intended to relate to both residential and nonresidential development, as well as mixed forms of development. There may be uses, now or in the future, which are not expressly permitted by the other terms of this chapter but which uses would not contravene the long-range Comprehensive Plan objectives if they adhere to certain predetermined performance and design conditions. The PUD is intended to be used to enable these developments to occur even though they may not be specifically authorized by the City zoning district regulations.
- (3) ~~The PUD is intended to be used in any area located within the PUDOD.~~ Should a proposed project offer community-wide benefits, the Common Council may establish a PUD in order to permit uses not explicitly allowed by the underlying zoning.
- (4) Areas may be zoned as a PUD by the Common Council. The enactment and establishment of such a zone shall be a legislative act. No owner of land or other person having an interest in land shall be entitled as a matter of right to the enactment or establishment of any such zone.

C. Establishment and location.

- (1) The intent of a PUD is to create self-contained, architecturally consistent, and compatible buildings, many times with diverse but related uses. The creation of a PUD must entail sufficient review to assure the uses within the zone will have negligible or no significant adverse effects upon properties surrounding the zone. In reaching its decision on whether to rezone to a PUD, the Common Council shall consider the general criteria set forth in this chapter, the most current Comprehensive Plan for the City, and this statement of purpose.
- (2) ~~No PUD shall be established pursuant to Subsection G(13) of this section unless it is located within the boundaries of the PUDOD, the boundaries of which can be seen on the attached map, "Boundary for the Planned Unit Development Overlay District~~

² ~~Editor's Note: Said map is on file in the City Clerk's office.~~

~~(PUDOD)–April 2018."~~

- D. Permitted principal and accessory uses.
- (1) In a PUD, buildings and land may be used for any lawful purpose permitted in the zone where it is located, plus any other uses which the Common Council may authorize.
 - (2) All development restrictions, including, but not limited to, yard size, height restriction, building coverage, and lot size, shall be as set forth in the legislation rezoning the area to a PUD established by the Common Council. In addition, the Common Council may impose any conditions or limitations that are determined to be necessary or desirable to ensure that the development conforms with the City Comprehensive Plan, including limiting the permitted uses, location and size of buildings and structures, providing for open space and recreational areas, requiring acoustical or visual screening, construction sequencing, and requiring bonds or other assurances of completion of any infrastructure to be built as part of the development.
- E. Site plan approval. No structure shall be erected or placed within a PUD, no building permit shall be issued for a building or structure within a PUD, and no existing building, structure, or use in a PUD shall be changed, unless the proposed building and/or use is in accordance with a site plan approved pursuant to the provisions of Chapter 276 of the City of Ithaca Code.
- F. Criteria. The Common Council will consider an application for any PUD on the following criteria, among others:
- (1) Does the project further the health and welfare of the community?
 - (2) Is the project in accordance with the City Comprehensive Plan?
 - (3) Does the project create at least one long-term significant community benefit?
- G. Application process. An applicant proposing a development that does not conform with the existing zoning requirements may apply for a PUD to be placed on his/her property, or on such other property as designated by the applicant and for which the applicant has submitted sufficient authorization executed by the owner(s) of said property in support of the application. The application process is as follows:
- (1) Staff/applicant pre-application meeting. An applicant seeking alternate zoning for his/her property must first contact the Department of Planning, Building, and Development for a pre-application meeting. Staff will explain the requirements, the application process, the timeline, and the fees associated with a PUD request.
 - (2) Application submission. The applicant must submit a completed PUD application along with the required fee. The application must include a conceptual development plan and an explanation of the request for alternate zoning. The conceptual plan must include the proposed sizes of yards, maximum heights and stories of all proposed buildings, maximum lot coverage, adjacent uses and adjacent zoning.
 - (3) Common Council~~Planning and Economic Development Committee~~. The ~~Planning~~

~~and Economic Development Committee of the Common Council~~ will consider the application for completion and will schedule a public information session. The developer will be expected to be present at this meeting.

- (4) Circulation. The ~~Planning and Economic Development Committee~~Common Council will also authorize and direct staff to circulate the proposal for review and comment from City boards/committees, the Tompkins County Planning Department, and any neighboring property owners within 500 feet of the proposed project. Comments and concerns will be forwarded to the applicant and to the Common Council for their consideration.
- (5) Public information session. Within 30 days of receiving a completed application, the City will schedule a public information session, at which the developer will be responsible for presenting information about the project and answering questions from the public. The City will advertise the public information session with a press release to the local media at least 15 days, but no more than 20 days, prior to the meeting. The applicant is responsible for posting the property at least five days prior to the public information session, with the date, time, and location of the meeting.
- (6) Committee recommendation. Once the comments have been received, the ~~Planning and Economic Development Committee~~Common Council will hold a legally noticed public hearing at a regularly scheduled committee meeting. The City will publish a legal notice of the hearing 15 days prior to the hearing. The Committee will consider all comments that have been received, as well as all comments made at the public hearing and will make a recommendation to the Common Council. The recommendation may include additional requirements or limitations to either mitigate undesirable impacts or to ensure the development conforms to the goals of the City's Comprehensive Plan.
- (7) Conditional approval. The Common Council will consider the request and may pass a resolution granting a conditional approval, subject to further site plan review approval and instructing staff to take the project through the environmental review process. Notwithstanding any conflicting provisions of the City Code, an applicant whose application has received approval in concept from the Common Council (approval in concept) shall be permitted, for the purpose of commencing site plan review, to proceed with a building permit application, despite any zoning-based deficiencies in the application, so long as all such deficiencies may be cured by final Council approval of the PUD.
- (8) Site plan review application. Applicant submits a site plan review application. The Planning Board commences the environmental review process in compliance with the State Environmental Quality Review Act (SEQRA) and the City Environmental Quality Review Ordinance (CEQRO) and conducts the normal site plan review process. To the extent that the Planning Board declares its intent to be the lead agency for the environmental review of the project and the PUD, the Planning Board notifies all other involved agencies including the Common Council.
- (9) (Reserved)

- (10) Common Council involvement. As a part of the environmental review process for the project and the PUD, the Planning Board will update the Common Council after each Planning Board meeting where the project is considered and will request ongoing written comments from the Common Council.
 - (11) (Reserved)
 - (12) Common Council consideration of the PUD. When and if the Planning and Development Board has completed its environmental review of the project to the extent required under SEQRA and CEQRO and has issued a contingent site plan approval or in the case of a multiphase project has issued a preliminary contingent site plan approval of multiple phases along with a final contingent site plan approval of at least one phase, the project will return to the Common Council for final consideration of the adoption of the PUD, which at Council's discretion may be authorized for one or all phases of a multiphase project. Final Council approval, if any, shall be granted via ordinance.
- H. Additional requirements. In any rezoning to a PUD, the Common Council may impose such conditions or limitations that the Council, in its legislative discretion, may determine to be necessary or desirable to ensure that the development conforms with the City Comprehensive Plan, including limiting the permitted uses, location and size of buildings and structures, providing for open space and recreational areas, and requiring bonds or other assurances of completion of any infrastructure to be built as part of the development.
- I. Expiration. A developer who receives PUD approval will have 24 months to begin construction of their project. If construction on the property has not been developed in accordance with the approved plan after 24 months, the PUD will automatically be revoked, unless otherwise stated by the Common Council, and the property will return to the previously approved zoning restrictions. In the case of extenuating circumstances, the developer may apply to the Common Council for an extension of PUD approval. If the site plan changes significantly, said significance as determined by the Director of Planning and Development, it may require reconsideration by the Common Council. The Director of Planning and Development may determine that the changes are minor and do not require reapproval.

Section 3. Severability Clause

Severability is intended throughout and within the provisions of this Ordinance. If any section, subsection, sentence, clause, phrase, or portion of this Ordinance is held to be invalid or unconstitutional by a court of competent jurisdiction, then that decision shall not affect the validity of the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This ordinance shall take effect immediately and in accordance with law upon publication of notices as provided in the Ithaca City Charter.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 E. Green St. — Third Floor Ithaca, NY 14850-5690

DEPARTMENT OF PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT

Lisa Nicholas, AICP, Director

Planning & Development – 607-274-6550

E-Mail: dgrunder@cityofithaca.org

Community Development/IURA – 607-274-6565

To: Robert Cantelmo, Mayor
Common Council
Adam Potter, Superintendent of Public Works
Rob Fell DeWalt, Director of Code Enforcement
Alan Karasin, Director of Department of Information & Community Engagement
City of Ithaca Department of Planning and Development
Katie Borgella, Tompkins County Commissioner of Planning and Sustainability
Sustainability & Climate Justice Commission
Planning & Development Board

Dominick Recckio, Acting City Manager
Victor Kessler, City Attorney
Shaniqua Lewis, Deputy City Clerk

From: Lisa Nicholas, Director of Planning & Development and Maura Baldiga, Senior Planner

Date: March 18, 2026

Re: Proposal to Allow Planned Unit Developments (PUDs) Citywide

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The purpose of this memo is to provide information about a proposal to allow Planned Unit Developments (PUDs) citywide. PUDs allow for more creative use of land than is permitted under current zoning, provided that a project has long-term community benefits and is compatible with the City's comprehensive plan. Currently, PUDs are restricted to the City's Planned Unit Development Overlay District (PUDOD). The proposed amendment would allow PUDs throughout the entire City, creating the opportunity for more progressive zoning while a lengthier comprehensive rewrite is underway. The [City's website](#) has additional information on PUDs and the application process.

Staff presented an overview of the process and existing PUDs in February 2025 to Common Council: [Planned Unit Development Common Council Presentation](#). The presentation's [slides](#) provide additional detail.

PROJECT HISTORY, BACKGROUND, & ANALYSIS

The Common Council adopted PUD legislation in 2014, which limited PUDs to industrially-zoned properties, a zoning district the City's code no longer includes. In 2017, the City expanded the PUDOD to include areas in the City where additional development was anticipated, specifically the Collegetown and waterfront districts. The PUDOD was expanded again in 2021 to include properties at the base of West Hill. A map of the current PUDOD boundaries is attached and available [online](#).

Currently the City has three PUDs: Founder's Way (former Immaculate Conception site), Cayuga Park, and SouthWorks. Information about these projects, including zoning and community benefits, can be found in the [presentation](#) referenced above.

The creation of a PUD is a legislative rezoning process at the sole discretion of Council and results in a unique zoning district with defined area and use requirements. Once adopted, a PUD becomes its own

zone in the City's Code and includes allowed uses, dimensional and bulk standards, and any other restrictions.

Like all zoning changes, Council decisions regarding a PUD are guided by community input, conformance with the comprehensive plan, compatibility with adjacent development, environmental concerns, and many other factors to ensure that the benefit of the new zoning proposal is balanced with other community needs and potential impacts.

§325-12.F. of the City Code outlines the following additional considerations specific to PUDs: (1) if the project furthers the health and welfare of the community, (2) if the project is in accordance with the City Comprehensive Plan, and (3) if the project creates at least one long-term significant community benefit.

Protection of the health and welfare of the community may include providing housing options, connections to transportation, or open space and recreational activities. Conformance with the City's Comprehensive Plan means the project should be consistent with, among other things, the future land use map. For example, a project in a traditional residential area should be of similar size, scale and intensity of use as the surrounding land use. Finally, long-term community benefits may include public or private open space, community recreational amenities, needed housing types and/or mix, innovative designs, and protection and/or preservation of natural resources or other benefits deemed appropriate by Common Council.

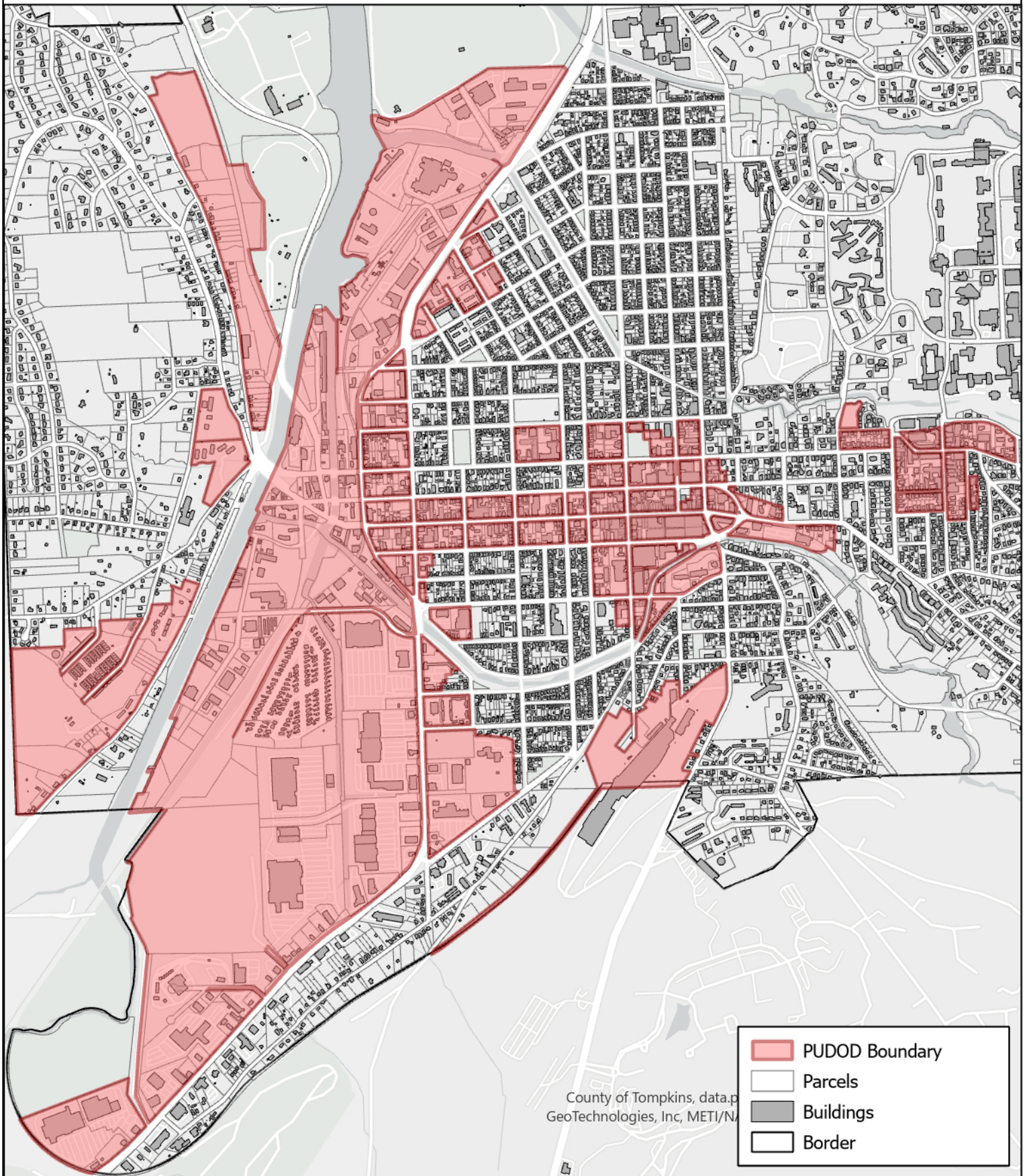
A PUD proposal is brought forward by a developer for a specific project, and Council can approve, deny or amend the proposal. The application process is outlined in §325-12.G. and includes opportunity for public information and comment, Site Plan Approval, environmental review and any conditions or limitations Council deems appropriate. Common Council can choose to approve or deny any PUD proposal.

Allowing PUDs citywide could create the opportunity for increased housing production by removing potential barriers, while also ensuring that Common Council retains control over the types of projects that are approved. Since PUDs require long-term community benefits, allowing PUDs in all areas of the City can enable high-quality, community-enhancing projects to be built through the City's neighborhoods.

COMMENTS AND PUBLIC HEARING

The full proposed ordinance and a Short Environmental Assessment Form are attached for your review. The Common Council will hold a public hearing on this proposal at its meeting on Wednesday, April 15, 2026 at 6 pm in the Common Council Chambers. Final consideration of the proposal will be held at the May 6, 2026 Common Council meeting. Your comments are respectfully requested by Tuesday April 14, 2026 but will still be considered through May 5, 2026. Please send all comments, or any questions, to mbaldiga@cityofithaca.org.

Planned Unit Development Overlay District (PUDOD) 2021- City of Ithaca, NY



0 500 1,000 2,000 3,000 Feet



NY State Plane, Central GRS 80 Datum
Map Source: Tompkins County Digital Planimetric Map 1991-2025
Data Source: City of Ithaca Department of Planning
Map Prepared by: Dept. of GIS, City of Ithaca, NY, February 2021

Short Environmental Assessment Form

Part 1 - Project Information

Instructions for Completing

Part 1 – Project Information. The applicant or project sponsor is responsible for the completion of Part 1. Responses become part of the application for approval or funding, are subject to public review, and may be subject to further verification. Complete Part 1 based on information currently available. If additional research or investigation would be needed to fully respond to any item, please answer as thoroughly as possible based on current information.

Complete all items in Part 1. You may also provide any additional information which you believe will be needed by or useful to the lead agency; attach additional pages as necessary to supplement any item.

Part 1 – Project and Sponsor Information			
Name of Action or Project: Planned Unit Development Amendment			
Project Location (describe, and attach a location map): City-wide			
Brief Description of Proposed Action: The proposed amendment would allow Planned Unit Developments citywide. Currently, PUDs are restricted to the City's Planned Unit Development Overlay District. The proposed amendment would allow PUDs throughout the entire City,			
Name of Applicant or Sponsor: City of Ithaca		Telephone: 607-274-6550 E-Mail:	
Address: 108 E Green Street			
City/PO: Ithaca		State: NY	Zip Code: 14850
1. Does the proposed action only involve the legislative adoption of a plan, local law, ordinance, administrative rule, or regulation? If Yes, attach a narrative description of the intent of the proposed action and the environmental resources that may be affected in the municipality and proceed to Part 2. If no, continue to question 2.		NO ☐	YES ☒
2. Does the proposed action require a permit, approval or funding from any other government Agency? If Yes, list agency(s) name and permit or approval:		NO ☐	YES ☐
3. a. Total acreage of the site of the proposed action? _____ acres b. Total acreage to be physically disturbed? _____ acres c. Total acreage (project site and any contiguous properties) owned or controlled by the applicant or project sponsor? _____ acres			
4. Check all land uses that occur on, are adjoining or near the proposed action: ☐ Urban ☐ Rural (non-agriculture) ☐ Industrial ☐ Commercial ☐ Residential (suburban) ☐ Forest ☐ Agriculture ☐ Aquatic ☐ Other(Specify): ☐ Parkland			

5. Is the proposed action,	NO	YES	N/A
a. A permitted use under the zoning regulations?	☐	☐	☐
b. Consistent with the adopted comprehensive plan?	☐	☐	☐
6. Is the proposed action consistent with the predominant character of the existing built or natural landscape?	NO	YES	
	☐	☐	
7. Is the site of the proposed action located in, or does it adjoin, a state listed Critical Environmental Area?	NO	YES	
If Yes, identify: _____	☐	☐	
8. a. Will the proposed action result in a substantial increase in traffic above present levels?	NO	YES	
b. Are public transportation services available at or near the site of the proposed action?	☐	☐	
c. Are any pedestrian accommodations or bicycle routes available on or near the site of the proposed action?	☐	☐	
9. Does the proposed action meet or exceed the state energy code requirements?	NO	YES	
If the proposed action will exceed requirements, describe design features and technologies: _____ _____	☐	☐	
10. Will the proposed action connect to an existing public/private water supply?	NO	YES	
If No, describe method for providing potable water: _____ _____	☐	☐	
11. Will the proposed action connect to existing wastewater utilities?	NO	YES	
If No, describe method for providing wastewater treatment: _____ _____	☐	☐	
12. a. Does the project site contain, or is it substantially contiguous to, a building, archaeological site, or district which is listed on the National or State Register of Historic Places, or that has been determined by the Commissioner of the NYS Office of Parks, Recreation and Historic Preservation to be eligible for listing on the State Register of Historic Places?	NO	YES	
	☐	☐	
b. Is the project site, or any portion of it, located in or adjacent to an area designated as sensitive for archaeological sites on the NY State Historic Preservation Office (SHPO) archaeological site inventory?	☐	☐	
13. a. Does any portion of the site of the proposed action, or lands adjoining the proposed action, contain wetlands or other waterbodies regulated by a federal, state or local agency?	NO	YES	
	☐	☐	
b. Would the proposed action physically alter, or encroach into, any existing wetland or waterbody?	☐	☐	
If Yes, identify the wetland or waterbody and extent of alterations in square feet or acres: _____ _____ _____			

14. Identify the typical habitat types that occur on, or are likely to be found on the project site. Check all that apply: ☐ Shoreline ☐ Forest ☐ Agricultural/grasslands ☐ Early mid-successional ☐ Wetland ☐ Urban ☐ Suburban		
15. Does the site of the proposed action contain any species of animal, or associated habitats, listed by the State or Federal government as threatened or endangered?	NO	YES
	☐	☐
16. Is the project site located in the 100-year flood plan?	NO	YES
	☐	☐
17. Will the proposed action create storm water discharge, either from point or non-point sources? If Yes, a. Will storm water discharges flow to adjacent properties? b. Will storm water discharges be directed to established conveyance systems (runoff and storm drains)? If Yes, briefly describe:	NO	YES
	☐	☐
	☐	☐
	☐	☐
18. Does the proposed action include construction or other activities that would result in the impoundment of water or other liquids (e.g., retention pond, waste lagoon, dam)? If Yes, explain the purpose and size of the impoundment:	NO	YES
	☐	☐
49. Has the site of the proposed action or an adjoining property been the location of an active or closed solid waste management facility? If Yes, describe:	NO	YES
	☐	☐
20. Has the site of the proposed action or an adjoining property been the subject of remediation (ongoing or completed) for hazardous waste? If Yes, describe:	NO	YES
	☐	☐
I CERTIFY THAT THE INFORMATION PROVIDED ABOVE IS TRUE AND ACCURATE TO THE BEST OF MY KNOWLEDGE Applicant/sponsor/name: <u>City of Ithaca</u> Date: <u>3/5/2026</u> Signature: <u>Maura Baldiga</u> Title: <u>Senior Planner</u>		

Project: Planned Unit Development Amendmen

Date: 3/5/2026

Short Environmental Assessment Form

Part 2 - Impact Assessment

Part 2 is to be completed by the Lead Agency.

Answer all of the following questions in Part 2 using the information contained in Part 1 and other materials submitted by the project sponsor or otherwise available to the reviewer. When answering the questions the reviewer should be guided by the concept “Have my responses been reasonable considering the scale and context of the proposed action?”

	No, or small impact may occur	Moderate to large impact may occur
1. Will the proposed action create a material conflict with an adopted land use plan or zoning regulations?	☒	☐
2. Will the proposed action result in a change in the use or intensity of use of land?	☒	☐
3. Will the proposed action impair the character or quality of the existing community?	☒	☐
4. Will the proposed action have an impact on the environmental characteristics that caused the establishment of a Critical Environmental Area (CEA)?	☒	☐
5. Will the proposed action result in an adverse change in the existing level of traffic or affect existing infrastructure for mass transit, biking or walkway?	☒	☐
6. Will the proposed action cause an increase in the use of energy and it fails to incorporate reasonably available energy conservation or renewable energy opportunities?	☒	☐
7. Will the proposed action impact existing:		
a. public / private water supplies?	☒	☐
b. public / private wastewater treatment utilities?	☒	☐
8. Will the proposed action impair the character or quality of important historic, archaeological, architectural or aesthetic resources?	☒	☐
9. Will the proposed action result in an adverse change to natural resources (e.g., wetlands, waterbodies, groundwater, air quality, flora and fauna)?	☒	☐
10. Will the proposed action result in an increase in the potential for erosion, flooding or drainage problems?	☒	☐
11. Will the proposed action create a hazard to environmental resources or human health?	☒	☐

Short Environmental Assessment Form Part 3 Determination of Significance

For every question in Part 2 that was answered “moderate to large impact may occur”, or if there is a need to explain why a particular element of the proposed action may or will not result in a significant adverse environmental impact, please complete Part 3. Part 3 should, in sufficient detail, identify the impact, including any measures or design elements that have been included by the project sponsor to avoid or reduce impacts. Part 3 should also explain how the lead agency determined that the impact may or will not be significant. Each potential impact should be assessed considering its setting, probability of occurring, duration, irreversibility, geographic scope and magnitude. Also consider the potential for short-term, long-term and cumulative impacts.

The proposed action is the adoption of an ordinance to allow Planned Unit Developments across the City of Ithaca. Currently, PUDs are only allowed in the City's Planned Unit Development Overlay District. It involves no physical alteration or construction, and no environmental impacts are anticipated from the adoption of the amendment. Future development under these regulations will remain subject to its own environmental review, which will be no less protective of the environment.

☐ Check this box if you have determined, based on the information and analysis above, and any supporting documentation, that the proposed action may result in one or more potentially large or significant adverse impacts and an environmental impact statement is required.	
☒ Check this box if you have determined, based on the information and analysis above, and any supporting documentation, that the proposed action will not result in any significant adverse environmental impacts.	
City of Ithaca Common Council	3/5/2026
Name of Lead Agency	Date
Robert G. Cantelmo	Mayor
Print or Type Name of Responsible Officer in Lead Agency	Title of Responsible Officer
	<i>Maura Baldiga</i>
Signature of Responsible Officer in Lead Agency	Signature of Preparer (if different from Responsible Officer)